

William Fawson, PhD

Postdoctoral Research Fellow
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Please feel free to connect with me on [LinkedIn](#).
 For further information, visit my [Personal Website](#).

Summary

My research examines how people build, maintain, and manage their reputations. In particular, I study how people signal competence and moral character to others. My research is currently under revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General* and *Nature Human Behaviour* and has been featured in *Forbes Magazine* and *Think*. I was recently awarded Early Career Scholar by the *International Association for Conflict Management*. At London Business School, I teach Personal Assessment and Development to students in the Masters in Finance program. I am also a guest lecturer in the Power & Influence (E)MBA elective at IESE Business School, where I earned my PhD. Before entering academia, I spent seven years working in finance and strategy consulting in London and Amsterdam. I hold a BSc in Economics and Politics from the University of Bath, an MBA from IESE Business School, and I am a Chartered Accountant in the United Kingdom.

Academic Positions

London Business School – London, United Kingdom	2025-
Postdoctoral Research Fellow (Advisor: Ena Inesi)	Present

Education

IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain	2021-25
PhD in Management	
• Dissertation: On the Nature, Antecedents and Effects of Status • Cum Laude (Distinction) • Advisors: Sebastien Brion, Anneloes Raes • Committee: Nicholas Hays, Robert Lount, Maya Rossignac-Milon	
IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain	2019-21
Master of Research in Management	
IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain	2014-16
Master of Business Administration	
Institute of Chartered Accountants of Scotland – Edinburgh, United Kingdom	2008-11
Chartered Accountant (CA) – Membership Number M27541	
University of Bath – Bath, United Kingdom	2004-07
Bachelor of Science in Economics and Politics	

Manuscripts under Revise and Resubmit

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of Punishing Power-holders

- Currently under revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*
- [Preprint available](#)
- Featured in [Forbes Magazine](#)
- Featured in London Business School's [Think](#)

Huber, J., Holzknicht, A., Schwaiger, R., Blanco, E., Kirchler, M., et al. (including **Fawson, W.**) Collective Evidence on Behavioral Interventions Targeting Carbon Pricing Support: A Many-Designs Approach with 55 Studies

- Currently under revise and resubmit at *Nature Human Behaviour*

Manuscripts under review

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. More Than a Consensus? A Social Relations Model Analysis of Status

- Currently under review at the *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*
- [Preprint available](#)

Fawson, W., Berman, J. Z., & Inesi, M. E. Right to Brag? The Reputational Consequences of Disclosing Prosocial Behavior

- Currently under review at the *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*
- [Preprint available](#)

Working Papers

Fawson, W. Deviating from the Status Consensus Reduces Psychological Safety (one study complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Fawson, W., Bechara, J. P., & Hays, N. A. Status Dissonance Leads to Subversive Status Conflict (two studies complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Lount, R. The Motivational Consequences of Status Variance (three studies complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2026)

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. The Negative Effect of Narcissism on Dyadic Status Exchanges (one study complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Invited Research Talks

London Business School – London, United Kingdom 2025
Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2024). Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of Punishing Power-holders

NEOMA Business School – Rouen, France 2023
Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). More Than a Consensus? A Social Relations Model Analysis of Status

Chaired Symposia

Fawson, W. (2023). Innovations in Research in Hierarchy. Chaired symposium at the 83rd *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Boston, United States*

- Contributors: William Fawson*, Nicholas Hays*, Zhiya Guo, Russell Eric Johnson, Rebecca Mitchell*, Catarina Fernandes, Jo K. Oh, Sebastien Brion, Anneloes Raes, Julian Pfrombeck*, Adam Galinsky, Lindred L. Greer*, Nicole Abi-Esber, and Annebel H.B. De Hoogh (*presenters)

Conference Papers and Talks

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2026). Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of Punishing Power-holders. Paper to be presented at the 86th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Philadelphia, United States*

Fawson, W., Inesi, M. E., & Berman, J. (2026). Right to Brag? The Reputational Consequences of Disclosing Prosocial Behavior. Paper to be presented at the 86th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Philadelphia, United States*

Fawson, W., & Brion, S. (2025). Beyond the Individual: Dyadic Drivers of Status. Paper presented at the 85th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Copenhagen, Denmark*

Fawson, W., & Hays, N. (2025). The Curvilinear Effect of Receiving Status Dissensus on Effort and Performance. In Zhu, G. (Organizer), *A Social Hierarchy Perspective on Navigating Interpersonal Relationships*. Paper presented at the 85th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Copenhagen, Denmark*

Fawson, W., & Bechara, J. P.* (2025). The Effect of Status Deservedness on Dyadic Status Conflict in Groups. Paper presented at the 20th *Annual Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research Conference, Rotterdam, Netherlands* (*presenter)

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2024). Patrolling the Powerful: Power Predicts the Reputational Consequences of Third-Party Punishment. Data Blitz presented at the 37th *Annual Conference of the International Association for Conflict Management, Singapore*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Dyadic Perspective on Extraversion Congruence and Status Perception in Groups. In Fawson, W. (Organizer), *Innovations in Research on Hierarchy*. Paper presented at the 83rd *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Boston, United States*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Theory of Dyadic Status Perception. Paper presented at the 18th *Annual Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research Conference, Seattle, United States*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Theory of Dyadic Status Perception. Paper presented at the 36th Annual Conference of the International Association for Conflict Management, Thessaloniki, Greece

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A.* (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Dyadic Perspective on Status Perception in Groups. Paper presented at the 21st European Association of Work and Organizational Psychology Congress, Katowice, Poland (*presenter)

Awards

- Winner: Early Career Scholar, *International Association for Conflict Management* 2023
- Nominated: Best Submission, *21st European Association of Work and Organizational Psychology Congress* 2023

Grants and Fellowships

- IESE Doctoral Grant 2021
- IESE Foundation Fellowship 2019
- IESE MBA Admissions Scholarship 2014

Teaching

- Lecturer, London Business School** – London, United Kingdom 2025-Present
- Personal Assessment and Development (Masters in Finance; core)
 - Instructor rating: 4.73/5 (based on 62 student surveys)
 - Skills for Success (Masters in Financial Analysis; core)
- Guest Lecturer, IESE Business School** – Barcelona, Spain 2021-Present
- Power & Influence (MBA/EMBA; elective)

Academic Service

- Service to IESE Business School** 2021-23
- Organised and chaired 48 one-hour Brown Bag seminars for speakers from IESE Business School, Bayes Business School, Esade and IE Business School
- Service to the Academy of Management** 2024-Present
- Reviewer for annual conferences
- Service to the International Association for Conflict Management** 2023-Present
- Reviewer for annual conferences
 - Speaker in 2024 Doctoral Student Workshop for the session “Managing the Interview Process”
- Service to the Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research** 2023-Present
- Reviewer for annual conferences

Work Experience

IESE Business School (www.iese.edu) – Barcelona, Spain Associate Director, Career Development Center	2017-19
• Devoted 300 hours to coaching MBA students on breaking into consulting • Built case interview training content, delivered sessions to 150-student consulting club and conducted more than 100 practice interviews • Brought six new consulting firms to campus • Increased placements in top-three strategy consultancies from 28 (year before joining) to 46 (year leaving)	
Monitor Deloitte (www.deloitte.com) – Amsterdam, Netherlands Strategy Consulting Manager (initially MBA Intern)	2015-17
• Developed growth strategy for a Polish energy provider • Led commercial activities in two départements for three months at a French energy provider • Managed recruitment of MBAs for Deloitte's Dutch practice	
IHG Hotels & Resorts (www.ihgplc.com) – London, United Kingdom Corporate Finance Manager	2012-14
• Analysed the company's financial performance and prepared the CFO to discuss results and outlook in Executive Committee meetings each month • Coordinated the company's annual budget process • Worked closely with Investor Relations to manage external analyst coverage • Calculated annual bonuses for corporate employees across the company	
EY (www.ey.com) – London, United Kingdom Audit Senior Associate (initially: Audit Associate)	2008-12
• Managed audits for a major UK-based telco • Supervised IPO on the New York Stock Exchange for a large software provider • Studied and passed exams to become a Chartered Accountant	

Languages

English: Mother Tongue

Italian: Good

Spanish: Good

French: Basic

Interests

I do my best to keep active, and particularly enjoy going to the gym, running, and hiking. Once in a while I take on big challenges—these have included five marathons in Barcelona, and cycling the 4,000km perimeter of the Iberian Peninsula

References

Anneloes Raes

Professor and Head of Department

Managing People in Organizations

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Sebastien Brion

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